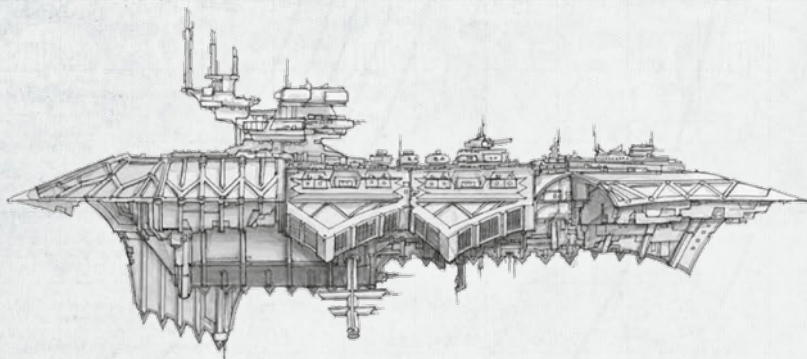


Famous Ships of the Gothic War: Horrific, Heartless Destroyer



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/8	25 cm	45°	2	5+	3
ARMAMENT	RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR		FIRE ARC
Port launch bays	Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		3 squadrons		–
Starboard launch bays	Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		3 squadrons		–
Dorsal lance battery	60 cm		2		Left/front/right
Prow weapons battery	60 cm		6		Left/front/right

The Styx class heavy cruiser was used throughout the Segmentum Obscurus and in many fleets of the Ultima Segmentum during the 32nd and 33rd millennia. In most fleets they were later phased out, in favour of the new battlecruisers being constructed on Mars. Mustering a considerable array of long range weapons batteries to complement its sizeable launch bays, the Styx is even more formidable than its considerable tonnage would suggest. There are seven recorded instances of Styx class heavy cruisers fighting against the forces of the Emperor in the Segmentum Obscurus before the Gothic War. During that conflict, this figure rose to thirty-nine major fleet battles involving Styx class ships, demonstrating the value the followers of the Ancient Powers placed on their capabilities. Although there were at least five ships of this class ranged against the Imperium during that campaign, only two were identifiable: the *Horrific* and the *Heartless Destroyer*. Both laid down in the Cypra Mundi dockyards in the early 33rd millennium, the *Heartless Destroyer* and *Horrific* were frequently in action together. In 299. M35 the *Heartless Destroyer*, the older of the two vessels, withdrew from an engagement against traitorous raiders, leaving its companion ship to be reduced to a hulk and captured. Until their reappearance during the Gothic War, there had been no more reports of either ship. Certain incidents when the two vessels fought together indicated there was still a great deal of enmity between them and in the Battle for Duran, the *Horrific* repaid the earlier treachery. It abandoned the Chaos fleet during the final assault of that battle and the *Heartless Destroyer* was crippled. The badly mauled heavy cruiser was then eventually destroyed when it drifted into range of planetary defence platforms.

FLEET LISTS

Chaos Incursion Fleet List (pg. 226), Black Crusade Fleet List (pg. 228), The Sorcerous Fleet (pg. 230), The Plaguefleet (pg. 232), The Berzerker Fleet (pg. 234), The Pleasurefleet (pg. 236)